

HelpMe Platform Build Summary

Build a simple web MVP for **HelpMe**.

HelpMe is a need-routing platform where users post what they need help with, and the system shows that request to relevant people based on skills, category, and location.

For now, build only the **web platform**, not a mobile app.

Core Concept

Users should be able to say:

- Help me find a job
- Help me build my career
- Help me review my pitch deck
- Help me build a website
- Help me move a couch
- Help me find a tutor
- Help me with startup advice

The platform should not work like Reddit, Fiverr, or Upwork. Users should not browse random posts or follow each other.

The flow should be:

User posts a need → system categorizes it → relevant helpers see it → helper shows interest → requester accepts → private chat opens → request is completed → both users rate each other.

MVP Web Flow

1. Landing Page

Build a premium, clean landing page with:

- Hero section
- "HelpMe with..." input box
- Examples of requests
- How it works section
- Remote help + local help explanation
- Trust and verification section
- CTA to sign up

Primary CTA:

Post what you need help with

Secondary CTA:

Offer help

2. Signup/Login

Users should create one account only.

No buyer/seller role split.

Every user can:

- Ask for help
- Offer help
- Do both

Signup fields:

- Name
- Email
- Phone
- Password
- City
- State
- Country

3. Onboarding

After signup, ask user:

What can you help with?

Skills/categories:

- Career Advice
- Resume Review
- Job Search Help
- Startup Advice
- Pitch Deck Review
- Website Design
- Marketing
- Tutoring
- Moving Help
- Elder Support

- Home Services
- Pet Care

User can select multiple skills.

Also ask:

- Remote help available? Yes/No
- Local help available? Yes/No
- Service radius for local help

4. Dashboard

Dashboard should show two tabs:

My Needs

Requests created by the user.

Help Feed

Requests matched to the user based on selected skills and location.

5. Create Request

User can create a request with:

- Title
- Description
- Category
- Location type: Remote / Local
- City/state if local
- Urgency: Today / This Week / Flexible
- Optional image/file upload

Example:

Title: Help me review my pitch deck

Description: I am applying to YC and need feedback on my pitch deck.

Category: Pitch Deck Review

Location: Remote

6. Smart Feed

Helpers should see requests relevant to them.

For MVP, routing can be simple:

- If request is Remote, show to users with matching skill/category.
- If request is Local, show to users with matching skill/category and same city/state.
- Sort by newest first.

No advanced AI matching required for MVP.

7. Interest Flow

On each request card, helpers can click:

I can help

This sends interest to the requester.

Requester can see interested helpers and choose:

- Accept
- Reject

Chat only opens after requester accepts a helper.

Do not allow random direct messaging.

8. Chat

Build a simple private chat between requester and accepted helper.

Support:

- Text messages
- Timestamp
- Basic conversation list

No video call needed.

9. Completion and Rating

Requester can mark request as:

- Completed

- Cancelled

After completion, both users can rate each other 1–5 stars and leave a short review.

10. User Profile

Profile should show:

- Name
- City/state
- Skills
- Rating
- Completed helps
- Verification status

11. Admin Panel

Simple admin panel for now:

- View users
- View requests
- View reported users
- View completed requests
- Block/suspend users

12. Tech Stack

Frontend:

- React
- Vite
- TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS

Backend:

- Node.js
- Express.js

Database:

- PostgreSQL

Authentication:

- JWT

Storage:

- Local file storage for MVP or S3-ready structure

Deployment:

- Web-first
- Responsive design
- Mobile-friendly web layout

13. Important MVP Rules

Do not build:

- Mobile app
- Payments
- Escrow
- Followers/following
- Public comments
- Bidding system
- Social media feed
- Video calls
- Complex AI matching

Focus only on:

Post need → match feed → interest → accept → chat → complete → rate

14. Design Direction

The platform should feel:

- Clean
- Trustworthy
- Modern
- Friendly
- Premium
- Simple

Use the positioning:

HelpMe — Tell us what you need help with.

Tagline:

Post a need. Get matched with people who can help.

15. Goal of MVP

The goal is not to build the final app.

The goal is to test whether users will:

1. Post real requests
2. Offer real help
3. Respond to matched requests
4. Complete help conversations
5. Come back again

If the web MVP gets traction, then build the mobile app later.